

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an example.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I now have that photo, and show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

It is very natural to assume that these questions must have determinate answers. There must be some fact of the matter about whether one of the people in the photo is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact of the matter about which one is you.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be
in this picture, and must be a fact about which of the survivors you are.

Then we can ask a question about these facts:

**The survival
question:** What does it
take for for some
person at some other
time to be you?

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be useful to think about a simple, uncontroversial example of survival.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person who will wake up in your bed tomorrow morning.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

This is the distinction between **numerical** and **qualitative** identity.

To say that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they are exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed tomorrow morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing different clothes.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow morning in that bed.

But then we can ask the survival question: in virtue of what are you numerically
the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?



**materialist
survival**

But this is not the only answer to our question. It is a widely held view that we are not simply material beings, but also have immaterial souls.

If one believes in immaterial souls, then it is natural to think
that one's survival is closely linked to the continued
existence of one's immaterial soul.

This suggests an alternative theory of survival. On this view,
the person who wakes up in that bed tomorrow is you
because they are, or have, the same immaterial soul.

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "soul survival" in white lowercase letters.

**soul
survival**

But these are not the only possible views here. One might also hold that you are that person not because of any physical connections, and not because of anything involving immaterial souls, but rather because of **psychological connections** between you and that person.

Which psychological connections? One popular approach focuses on memories. On this view, the thing which makes you the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed tomorrow is your shared memories.

Of course there are plenty of other psychological connections you will have to that person as well. You will have very similar beliefs and desires, and very similar personalities.

Let's call the idea that you are the same person because of
your psychological connections **psychological survival**.



**psycho-
logical
survival**

It is worth pausing to think about the differences between the soul theory and the psychological theory of survival. At a first glance, they can look like the same thing. But they are not.

In ordinary language, 'soul' is sometimes used as a synonym for 'mind.' But remember that in the present context a soul is an immaterial thing which is closely connected to your identity.

Once we have our three 'pure' theories on the table, it is clear that we can combine them in various ways. For example, one common view is that we are not just a material thing and not just an immaterial soul, but a kind of combination of the two.

Someone with this view might think that, because we are a combination of a body and soul, our continued existence requires the continued existence of both parts of that combination. We might call this 'M+S', since it is the view that survival requires **both** materialist survival and soul survival.

M

+

S

Similarly, we could require both material and psychological continuity — $M+P$ — or require both psychological connections and the continued existence of a soul — $P+S$.

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+

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the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are employed in the public sector has increased by 1.5 million, from 2.5 million in 1980 to 4 million in 1998 (Department of Health 1999). The number of people employed in the health sector has increased by 1.2 million, from 2.2 million in 1980 to 3.4 million in 1998.

There is a growing emphasis on the need to improve the quality of care and services provided by the public sector. This has led to a number of initiatives, including the introduction of the Health Care Act 1999, which sets out a framework for the regulation of health care providers, and the establishment of the Health Care Commission, which is responsible for monitoring and improving the quality of care and services provided by the public sector.

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